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Transcripción de audio

IELTS Academic · Set 17

01 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 1: Reserva de una reparación doméstica

Agent: Good afternoon, Hartley Home Repairs. How can I help you today?

Customer: Hello. I'd like to arrange for someone to come and fix a few things at my house.

Agent: Of course, I can help with that. Can I take your name, please?

Customer: Yes, it's David Whitfield.

Agent: Before we move on to the specific arrangements, I should explain how I handle a home-repair booking. I will begin with what matters most to you, then compare the practical options, and finally read the record back. That gives us a chance to correct a misunderstanding before anything is confirmed.

Customer: That approach sounds sensible for the home-repair booking. I made some notes beforehand, although I was not sure whether every detail I found still applied, so I would rather verify it during this conversation.

Agent: And could you spell your surname for me?

Customer: Certainly. It's W-H-I-T-F-I-E-L-D.

Agent: Thank you, Mr Whitfield. And what's your address?

Customer: It's 15 Maple Avenue.

Customer: For this home-repair booking, I am interested in what will work consistently. I need to understand what the standard arrangement includes and what would count as an optional extra, because changing plans later could be inconvenient.

Agent: Of course. In this home-repair booking, I will distinguish what is included from what can be added, and you can stop me whenever two alternatives sound too similar.

Agent: Maple Avenue, got it. And the postcode?

Customer: It's LS9 4RT.

Agent: Lovely. And what's the best number to reach you on?

Customer: My mobile is 078 4419 2036.

Agent: A home-repair booking can involve names, dates and choices that are easy to confuse on a first hearing. I will therefore use the full wording and repeat any number in a separate group. Please ask immediately if something conflicts with your notes.

Customer: I will. For the home-repair booking, accuracy matters more than finishing quickly, especially because I may need to coordinate this with another commitment.

Agent: And when's the best time for us to call you, if we need to?

Customer: In the evenings, please. I'm at work all day.

Agent: Noted - evenings. Now, could you describe the problems for me?

Customer: Well, the main thing is a leak. There's water coming in from the roof whenever it rains heavily.

Agent: Let me finish the home-repair booking by summarising what I have recorded. For this home-repair booking, I will separate confirmed details from pending ones, spell any unusual word, and explain what happens next. The summary closes the home-repair booking, so even a minor correction is worth making now.

Customer: Good. During the home-repair booking, I will listen carefully and confirm each point as you read it.

Agent: A leak from the roof - I'll make a note of that. Anything else?

Customer: Yes, there's also a broken fence in the back garden that needs repairing.

Agent: A broken fence. And when would suit you for our visit?

Customer: I'd prefer the morning - oh, actually, no. Make it the afternoon. I have to take the children to school first.

Customer: Before we close the home-repair booking, could you tell me how I should raise a question after today? I would prefer not to repeat the whole enquiry if one detail changes.

Agent: Certainly. Keep the reference on the confirmation and quote it when you contact us. A colleague can then see the agreed record, identify the single point that needs attention and explain whether the change affects anything else.

Agent: The afternoon it is. And how will our technician get in if you're not at home?

Customer: I'll leave a spare key with a neighbour. They're always in.

Agent: Perfect. Now let me tell you about our two maintenance plans. The basic plan includes two visits a year, with a call-out fee of £45 each time, but it does include free parts.

Customer: And the other one?

Agent: Before I close this home-repair booking, I will separate the details we have confirmed from the points that remain optional. Please listen to the complete summary before responding, because correcting one item can sometimes affect a later choice as well. I will keep the original order so that it is easy to compare with your notes.

Customer: That is helpful. I will check each detail as you read it and ask about anything that does not match what I intended. Once the summary is accurate, I will also note the reference and the method for making a later amendment.

Agent: The premium plan gives you four visits a year. With that plan the call-out fee drops to £30, and it also includes free labour.

Customer: The premium sounds better. I'll go with that one.

Agent: Excellent choice, Mr Whitfield. I'll get that booked in for you.

02 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 2: Visita guiada a una galería de arte

Good morning everyone, and welcome to the Riverside Art Gallery. My name's Karen, and I'll be your guide this morning. Before we begin, let me tell you about a few improvements we've made recently. The most exciting addition is our new rooftop café, which opened last month and has wonderful views over the river. We've also created a brand-new workshop room for children on the second floor, where families can take part in hands-on activities. Now, some of you have asked about the gift shop and the members' lounge - those have been here for years - and our audio guide app, I'm afraid, is still being developed and isn't available yet. Before describing the individual features of this art-gallery tour, it is useful to understand the overall sequence.

The information for the art-gallery tour follows the order in which most people encounter the site or activity, starting with the shared facilities before turning to optional activities. Knowing that sequence will make the later directions and choices in the art-gallery tour easier to follow. Right, let me explain how the tour works. The tour lasts about 90 minutes, and we'll finish back here at the main entrance. Please note that photography is allowed, but only without flash, as bright light can damage the older paintings. If you'd like to leave your bags, there are free lockers next to the cloakroom. Some arrangements connected with the art-gallery tour may look familiar while serving a slightly different purpose.

During the art-gallery tour, listen for the difference between a permanent feature and something available only at a stated time. Where a condition in the art-gallery tour is fixed, it will be presented as a rule; where there is flexibility, it will be described as a recommendation. We'll start in the East Wing, which houses the gallery's collection of landscape paintings. The highlight there is a work called 'The Harvest', which the gallery bought at auction in 2019 for a record price. From there, we move to the sculpture garden, where I'd ask you to please stay on the path, as the grass has just been reseeded. As the art-gallery tour continues, busy points may require visitors to leave additional space. Within the art-gallery tour, a change to a minor detail does not necessarily alter the main programme. If an alternative becomes necessary during the art-gallery tour, wait for the full announcement before moving, because the first place mentioned may be the one that is no longer available. Do not try to memorise every detail of the art-gallery tour at once. Later examples will clarify the distinctions introduced here. For now, concentrate on where the activity begins, which direction or sequence applies, and the point at which you may need to make a choice or ask a member of staff. After the sculpture garden, we visit the portrait gallery on the first floor. Many of these portraits were donated by a local collector whose family owned the building in the nineteenth century. The final room on the tour is the print room, which is kept quite dark to protect the delicate drawings.

A final way to follow the art-gallery tour is to separate descriptive information from an instruction that requires action. Background detail explains the setting, while a direct instruction changes what you should do next. Keeping those functions separate will prevent an interesting detail from being mistaken for a change to the programme. At the end of the tour, you're welcome to relax in the café, and don't forget that gallery members receive a ten percent discount in the shop. If you have any questions along the way, please feel free to ask me at any time. Now, if you'd all like to follow me,

we'll make our way to the East Wing. If you become uncertain during the art-gallery tour, pause at the next staffed point rather than following another group without checking.

Explain the last location or instruction you clearly remember, and staff can reconnect you with the correct sequence. This is especially important when two activities begin near one another or when a temporary diversion changes only one section of the route. The programme is designed to allow questions, so asking for clarification will not make you miss the main activity.

03 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 3: Conversación sobre un estudio de ciencias del deporte

Tutor: So, Amy and Josh, thanks for coming in. I've read your draft proposal for the sports-science study. Perhaps you could start by reminding me what you're actually trying to find out.

Amy: Well, originally we wanted to look at how diet affects sprinting speed, but we decided that was too broad. So now we're focusing specifically on how the amount of sleep athletes get affects their reaction times.

Tutor: Before we settle on an interpretation for the sports-science study, we should separate what the evidence actually shows from what we expected to find. Our first idea may still help organise the work, but it should not decide how we describe the result.

Amy: Agreed. For the sports-science study, we can return to the research question before revising the explanation. That will make the argument more credible.

Tutor: Good - that's a much sharper focus. And who are your participants?

Josh: We're recruiting university students, but only ones who already play sport competitively. We thought about using complete beginners, but their results would be too inconsistent.

Amy: We also need to be careful about cause and association in the sports-science study. Two patterns can occur together without one necessarily producing the other, particularly when the sample is small, participants select themselves, or an uncontrolled factor affects both.

Tutor: Yes. Describing that limitation clearly strengthens the project.

Tutor: Sensible. Now, how exactly are you measuring reaction time?

Amy: We're using a light-based test. A light flashes and the participant presses a button as quickly as they can. The software records the delay in milliseconds.

Tutor: Another question is whether our categories for the sports-science study are precise enough for somebody else to repeat the procedure. We know what we intended because we designed it, but a reader only has the written definition.

Amy: For the sports-science study, let us record the decision rule instead of relying on intuition. That should reveal any ambiguity before the final version.

Tutor: And have you run into any difficulties yet?

Josh: The main problem has been getting participants to attend at the same time each day. Reaction times vary depending on the time of day, so if people come at different hours, that adds noise to the data.

Amy: The order of the sports-science study presentation matters as much as the individual sections. If we give every technical detail before explaining the central question, the audience may lose the thread.

Tutor: For the sports-science study, we can rank the evidence by relevance and keep the strongest pattern in the main account.

Tutor: That's a really important point. Consistency of timing matters enormously. So what have your early results shown?

Tutor: Our final review of the sports-science study should use the agreed criteria rather than simply whether we like the finished version. We need consistent terminology, evidence for each claim and a conclusion that answers the question without exaggeration.

Amy: I will turn those points into a checklist. Then we can assign one person to verify the data and another to test the explanation.

Amy: This is the surprising bit. We expected that less sleep would always mean slower reactions, but actually, for the fittest participants, one bad night didn't seem to affect them much at all. It seems fitness might protect against short-term sleep loss.

Tutor: Fascinating. That's genuinely worth exploring. Now, in terms of next steps, I'd strongly recommend increasing your sample size - twenty participants really isn't enough to draw firm conclusions.

Amy: We should keep a note of any decision we change during the final review of the sports-science study, including the reason for it.

Tutor: Agreed. That record will stop us from reopening settled points without new evidence, and it will show which revision corrected a real weakness rather than merely changing the wording.

Josh: We were worried about that.

Tutor: Also, you should keep a log of each participant's caffeine intake, because that clearly influences alertness. And I'd like you to add a short questionnaire about their usual sleep patterns. Finally, make sure you get ethical approval before you start testing - the committee meets next Tuesday.

Tutor: Before we finish the sports-science study, let us read the argument from the perspective of somebody who did not collect the evidence. Each claim should identify what was observed, how it was measured and which limitation affects the interpretation.

Amy: I will also check that our recommendation follows from the result rather than from what we expected at the beginning. If a sentence sounds stronger than the method allows, we can narrow it without losing the main point.

Tutor: Good. Then the final version will show a clear line from the research question through the evidence to the conclusion.

Amy: Thank you, that's really helpful.

04 Comprensión auditiva - Sección 4: La imprenta

Today I'm going to talk about one of the most influential inventions in human history: the printing press. Although we often credit Johannes Gutenberg with inventing printing in the fifteenth century, forms of printing existed long before him. In China, printers were using carved wooden blocks to reproduce texts as early as the seventh century. The Chinese also experimented with movable type made from clay, but because the Chinese writing system uses thousands of different characters, the method never became widely practical there. To place the printing-press lecture in perspective, we need to distinguish the familiar modern description from the longer process that produced it.

Within the printing-press lecture, what now appears stable often emerged through competing explanations that were tested under different conditions. A simple list of events in the printing-press lecture can hide those alternatives, so the discussion will emphasise why particular changes mattered. Gutenberg's crucial innovation, developed in the German city of Mainz around 1440, was movable type made from metal. He created a special alloy that was durable enough to be reused thousands of times, and he designed a mould that allowed individual letters to be produced quickly and in large quantities. He also adapted the design of the wine press, which was already common in the region, to apply even pressure to the paper. Evidence for the printing-press lecture does not come from a single source.

Researchers may compare physical traces, written records, measurements and observations. Each source answers a different question and carries its own uncertainty. Agreement can increase confidence, while disagreement often reveals an assumption or a measurement problem that deserves closer examination. Scale is especially important when evaluating the printing-press lecture. A process observed in one case, one community or one short trial may behave differently across a region or over several generations. In this printing-press lecture, changes in measurement must not be confused with changes in reality. This comparison helps identify which conditions are essential and which are merely helpful. Another essential element was ink.

Gutenberg developed a new oil-based ink that stuck properly to the metal type - earlier water-based inks simply slid off. His most famous product was a printed Bible, completed around 1455, which is admired even today for the beauty of its printing. It is also worth noticing the language of certainty used in the printing-press lecture. Some mechanisms are supported by direct observation, while others remain the best explanation available from indirect evidence. Uncertainty can be described without abandoning a well-supported explanation. Keep that distinction in mind as the examples are brought together. The consequences of the printing press were enormous. Before printing, books were copied by hand, usually by monks, which made them extremely expensive and rare.

After Gutenberg, the price of books fell dramatically, and literacy began to spread among ordinary people. Ideas could now travel faster than ever before. Historians often argue that the printing press made the religious movement known as the Reformation possible, because pamphlets could be produced and distributed on a massive scale. The separate examples in the printing-press lecture can finally be organised around three questions: what conditions begin a change, which mechanisms sustain it, and what consequences appear later. For the printing-press lecture, the

framework is useful only if exceptions and limits remain visible. The conclusion to the printing-press lecture will use that framework to connect the details without extending them beyond the available evidence.

A useful final check is to ask what observation would make the present account of the printing-press lecture less convincing. Identifying such evidence keeps the explanation testable and reveals where future research would be most informative. It also prevents a plausible narrative from being treated as complete merely because its separate examples fit together. The press also had a profound effect on science. Accurate diagrams could be reproduced identically in every copy of a book, which helped scholars across Europe share knowledge reliably. Some historians claim that without the printing press, the Scientific Revolution could not have happened. By the year 1500, presses across Europe had already produced millions of books, transforming society permanently.

One final point about the printing-press lecture concerns the difference between a useful model and a complete explanation. A model selects the relationships that matter most for a particular question, so it can be informative even when it leaves out local variation. Problems arise when that simplification is forgotten and a result from one scale is treated as a rule for every case. The evidence discussed here should therefore be read with its conditions attached: the period observed, the population or material studied, the method used and the uncertainty that remains. Those conditions do not weaken the account; they show exactly where the conclusion is supported and where further observation would be needed.